

FAQs regarding 2025 Puja Registration

*Note: FAQs are guidelines for patrons and may be used a reference.
It is subject to change and the information noted herein may not
reflect changes made in future.*

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Feedback on FAQ or new queries may be sent by email to:
registration@durgabari.org

2025 Durga Puja Registration FAQ

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A. General Registration

Q1. How much is Puja registration fees?

A. Click [here](#) for puja registration fees. Early bird discount ends on Sept 7th. Registration fee is higher after Sept 7th.

Q2. How many members are typically considered in a family.

A. A family can have up to 5 members, typically two parents and up to three children under 22.

Q3 What meals will be served during Durga Puja event?

A. Following meals will be served for all registered members: Dinners every day from Thurs (Oct 2nd) thru Sun (Oct 5th) and lunches on Sat (Oct 4th) and Sun (Oct 5th). In addition, there will be snacks available for purchase.

Q4. Why has Registration fee gone up from last year?

A. We strive to keep operating expenses low to make the event affordable. However, market inflation, closing expenses gap and strong line up of cultural events are key drivers for cost escalation.

Q5 What is the age cut off for Seniors?

A. Anyone above 70 years is considered a senior.

B. Student Registration

Q1. Who can register as a student?

A. Only current full-time students are eligible to register as students. Students need to submit evidence of enrollment in full-time program during current year. For details, click [here](#) and see “General Guidelines”.

Q2. Will students have to become a member to register?

A. Membership is waived for eligible students.

C. Out of Towners Registration

Q1. Who are considered out of towners?

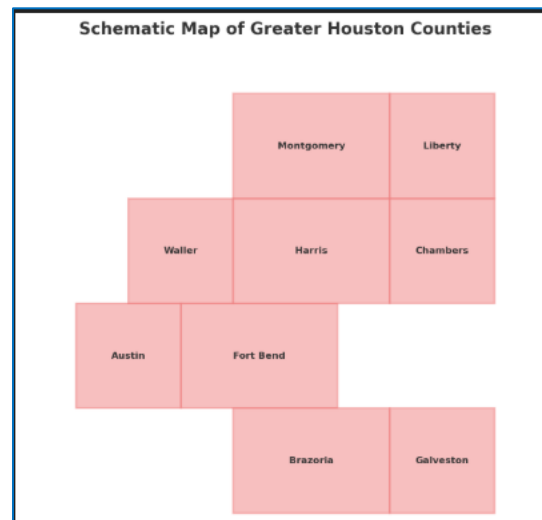
A. Out of towners are visitors residing outside the Greater Houston jurisdiction.

Q2. What are the counties considered within Greater Houston?

A. Following counties are part of Greater Houston: Austin, Brazoria, Chambers, Fort Bend, Galveston, Harris, Liberty, Montgomery, and Waller are included in Greater Houston. Similarly, cities like Katy, Fulshear, Galveston, Sugarland, The Woodlands, Conroe, Clear Lake are considered within Greater Houston. See counties map below. (Source: Wikipedia)

Q3. Where shall I stay as I am visiting Houston for Durga Puja

A. We do not have any discounted rates in nearby hotels for the event. Temple is located at 13944 Schiller Road, Houston, TX 77082. There are several hotels within 15 miles from the temple.



Counties of Greater Houston

D. Membership

Q1. Will my registration fee be less if I am a member.

A. Yes, members pay a reduced registration fee. Click [here](#) for fee details.

Q2. What are the benefits of becoming a member?

A. Click [here](#) to view list of member benefits.

E. Passes

Q1. What is a Pass?

A. A pass (whole day) is intended for out-of-town (OOT) visitors who plan to enjoy the event for either entire day or just an evening. Pass holder is eligible to get meals served at Durgabari and can also attend the cultural program during the session when pass is valid.

Q2. Who is eligible for a pass?

A. Out of Towners are eligible for pass on any day of the puja event. Greater Houston residents are not eligible for pass on Friday (Oct 3) or Saturday (Oct 4) of the puja event; they are eligible to get the pass for other days. One exception for Greater Houston resident - If parents are registered, then their child residing in GH area (even if above 22y), can apply for pass for any day.

Q3. When will pass applications be taken?

A. Application for pass will begin on 17th August and it will be allocated on first come/first serve basis during Sept 8th . Click [here](#) and then select “Special Processing” to apply for pass. Please note that issuance of pass is subject to availability and the applicant will be notified when it becomes available. Please note that in case there are excessive registrants, then pass allocation will be curtailed.

Q4. What is the cost of pass?

A. Pass is available for either individuals or families. Cost of day pass will be listed under “Special Processing” at our website and it varies from one day to another.

Q5. Are food coupons sold during the event?

A. Only limited number of food coupons are issued based on availability at the time of the meal being served. It cannot be issued in advance or purchased online. Onsite food coupons are issued based on an assessment made by kitchen team based on turnout for the event. Visit registration booth for the timing and cost of food coupons.

F. Sponsorship

Q1. Will I get parking if I become a sponsor?

A. Yes, a sponsor will be eligible for parking. Location of parking depends on level of sponsorship. Please click [here](#) for details.

Q2. What are various privileges of a sponsor?

A. Durgabari is a non-profit organization and provides temple services all year round. The expenses are supported by the patrons of Durgabari and we earnestly request you to consider sponsorship. Sponsorship has several privileges during the puja event and they vary based on level of sponsorship. Click [here](#) to see the different sponsorship categories and their privileges.

Q3. Do I have to pay for registration if I become a sponsor?

A. Registration fee is separate from sponsorship. All sponsors (except Diamond sponsor at \$5K+) must register first to be eligible for sponsorship.

Q4. Will my donation from current year count towards sponsorship?

A. Yes, year-to-date (YTD) donation will count towards sponsorship. However, donation will not count towards registration. One needs to register first and then year-to-date donation can be counted towards sponsorship.

Q5. Will the sponsorship amount have a tax benefit?

A. Durgabari (HDBS) is a non-profit organization. At the end of calendar year, HDBS will mail a receipt for the donation received to all eligible donors.

Q6. When will a sponsor be able to pick up parking decal?

A. Parking decal will be distributed starting Sept 21st (Anandamela).

G. Parking

Q1. How can I secure a parking spot within Durgabari premises?

A. All sponsors will be allocated parking for one vehicle. Parking location will be based on sponsorship level assigned. Click [here](#) to view sponsorship levels and parking locations.

Q2. How can I get a parking spot within Durgabari without sponsorship?

A. Requests for parking will be accepted from general registrants beginning Aug 17th. Requests may be made by selecting “[Special Processing](#)” icon at Puja registration portal. Parking will be assigned in September based on priority starting with senior citizens. All applicants who can be assigned a parking spot, will receive an email with link for making payment. If the payment is not made within a specified period, the allocation will be forfeited and passed to next in line.

Q3 When can one pick up parking decal?

A. Parking decal may be picked up from registration booth at Durgabari starting Sept 21st. Parking decals will also be distributed at other times as well; please see HDBS newsletter for additional pick up timings.

Q4. When is the parking decal valid?

A. Parking decal will be required from Thursday (Oct 2nd) thru Sunday (Oct 5th) and Kali Puja. Parking decal must be affixed on windshield (driver’s side) of a vehicle. Decal is not transferrable and may be used in designated area only.

Q5. Will parking decal be needed for Anandamela (Mahalaya) on Sept 21st or Inauguration Ceremony on Sept 27th?

A. No parking decal is needed for either event.

Q6. Where should I park if I do not get a decal?

A. We recommend parking at West Oaks Mall parking lot. It is about 2 miles from Durgabari. There will be free shuttle service between Durgabari and Mall at regular intervals every day from morning until late night (end of cultural program) during the puja event. There are couple of nearby parking areas; but they are not managed by Durgabari. Moreover, the walk to the temple from such nearby parking locations is along a narrow road with high traffic volume; please avoid walking.

H. Diamond Sponsorship

Q1. Does a Diamond sponsor have to register?

A. No, registering is optional for a Diamond sponsor.

Q2. What are the privileges of Diamond Sponsorship?

A. Click [here](#) to see the list of privileges for a Diamond sponsor.

I. Inauguration Ceremony

Q1. Who can attend the inauguration ceremony on Sept 27th evening?

A. Inauguration Ceremony is being held to celebrate 25th anniversary of Durgabari. All are welcome to attend.

Q2. How do I get dinner coupon for ceremony before Sept 27th if I missed to buy it during online registration?

A. Registered patrons may contact registration team to purchase dinner coupons. Cost is \$10 per person before Sept 7th and \$15 after Sept 7th. Non registered visitor may purchase dinner coupon during the event and number of such coupons will be subject to availability.